

Individual Project – Carry-Out Mark-Scheme

Criteria	0-39% (F, D-) Poor	40-49% (D, D+) Satisfactory	50-59% (C-, C, C+) Good	60-69% (B-, B, B+) Very Good	70-89% (A-, A, A+) Excellent	90-100% (A*) Outstanding
<i>Approach</i> [25%]	Student demonstrated little to no ability to plan and carry out independent research. Student took no ownership of the project and was unable to manage the project within the time-frame allocated.	Student demonstrated a very limited ability carry out independent research. Student took little to no ownership of the project and extensive supervisor input was necessary for objectives to be met within the time-frame allocated	Student demonstrated a limited ability to plan and carry out independent research. Student took ownership of aspects of the project, but extensive supervisor input was necessary. Some issues with time management.	Student demonstrated an ability to plan and carry out independent research and with supervisor's support. Student took ownership of aspects of the project, building on moderate supervisor input, and successfully managed the project within the time-frame allocated.	Student demonstrated an excellent ability to plan and carry out independent research and to overcome difficulties. Student took ownership of the project, exploring widely, setting appropriate goals and successfully managed the project within the time-frame allocated.	Very little could be done to better it in any way
<i>Technical Skills</i> [30%]	Student demonstrated little to no ability in developing and utilizing any computational, analytical and/or experimental tools necessary for their project.	Student demonstrated a limited ability to develop and use the computational, analytical and/or experimental tools provided for their project. Results were obtained with significant assistance.	Student demonstrated an ability to develop and use the computational, analytical and/or experimental tools for necessary for their project. Results were obtained with some assistance.	Student demonstrated the ability to identify appropriate computational, analytical and/or experimental tools necessary for their project, effectively developing and utilizing them with little support.	Student demonstrated an excellent ability to identify the most appropriate computational, analytical and/or experimental tools necessary for their project, effectively developing and utilizing them. Minimal to no support was required.	
<i>Reporting</i> [20%]	Student provided few or no updates on their progress. Limited information was provided and generally not in an appropriate format. Poor communication skills overall.	Student provided some updates on their progress, in a less-than regular basis, important information was often missing and significant probing by the supervisor was necessary. Limited communication skills evident.	Student provided good, regular updates on their progress, however some important information was often missing and significant probing by the supervisor was necessary.	Student provided very good, regular updates on their progress, however some probing by the supervisor was necessary. Very good communication skills overall.	Student provided excellent, regular updates on their progress in an appropriate format. Little to no probing by the supervisor was necessary. Excellent communication skills overall.	
<i>Diligence</i> [10%]	No significant student effort was evident throughout the duration of the project.	Some student effort was evident throughout the duration of the project, however falling well short of the expected level.	Student worked diligently throughout the project with effort however failing to meet the expected level.	Student worked diligently throughout the project with effort up to the expected level.	Student worked diligently throughout the project with effort well beyond the expected level.	
<i>Originality</i> [15%]	No originality in the approach employed and the findings presented. Work presented is of a poor standard.	No originality in the approach employed and the findings presented, however work is of satisfactory standard.	While not original in its approach, the work has developed some novel findings.	Good mixture of established approaches employed and novel ones developed. Some novel findings presented.	Innovative approaches and novel findings, that go beyond the scope of the task, employed.	

Individual Project – Thesis Mark-Scheme

Criteria	0-39% (F, D-) Poor	40-49% (D, D+) Satisfactory	50-59% (C-, C, C+) Good	60-69% (B-, B, B+) Very Good	70-89% (A-, A, A+) Excellent	90-100% (A*) Outstanding
<i>Introduction & Background</i> [15%]	Demonstrates very little evidence of having read basic background or understanding of the project objectives.	Demonstrates limited, fragmented knowledge of the background and literature; presents limited understanding of the project objectives.	Demonstrates a modest, partially integrated knowledge of the background and literature; presents some modest understanding of the project objectives.	Demonstrates well integrated knowledge of the background and literature through use of appropriate citations; presents pertinent understanding of the project objectives.	Demonstrates an excellent, well integrated knowledge of the background and literature through use of appropriate citations; presents exceptional understanding of the project objectives and their origins.	Very little could be done to better it in any way
<i>Methodology</i> [15%]	Chosen methods and assumptions not appropriate for the stated problem, very little detail of assumptions and reasoning provided.	Chosen approaches somewhat appropriate to problem statement. Some details related to assumptions and reasoning provided.	While somewhat limited in level of detail on reasoning, mostly appropriate methods chosen.	Appropriate methods and assumptions to the problem statement are employed. Good detail of reasoning provided.	Excellent choice of methods and use-cases. Rationale for choices clearly presented. Novel approaches to the stated problem found.	
<i>Validity of Results</i> [15%]	Presents poorly constructed set of results in inappropriate graphical, figurative or tabulated forms. The results are however mostly wrong and invalid.	Presents limited results in reasonable graphical, figurative or tabulated forms. Results are imprecise and to be questioned.	Presents most relevant results in a mostly appropriate graphical, figurative or tabulated form. Results contain errors and are sometimes elusive.	Presents all results in the most appropriate form. Results are mostly correct but minor issues identified.	Presents all results in in the most appropriate form allowing easy comparison and comprehension of trends. Results are accurate throughout.	
<i>Discussion of Findings</i> [20%]	Demonstrates incomplete or incorrect interpretation of trends indicating lack of understanding of results	Demonstrated limited thoughts and arguments; limited explanations of findings and ideas from results and literature; limited argument and discussion of the work.	Demonstrated a reasonable level of understanding of the key ideas and phenomena investigated; some key findings are related to ideas from literature; sustains some modest arguments; present some discussion of the work as a whole.	Demonstrated clear thoughts and arguments; explained findings and related well to concepts and findings from literature; provides clear and sound arguments that are well defended; presents a well round discussion of the work as a whole.	Demonstrated an independence of thought and arguments, indicating wide exploration; explains rationale clearly and provides lucid, cogent and sophisticated arguments that are well substantiated and defended; present a thorough and critical account of the work as a whole.	
<i>Conclusions</i> [10%]	Demonstrates poor conclusions; no evidence or attempt to answer the project objectives.	Demonstrated limited conclusions; limited evidence on attempt to answer the project objectives.	Demonstrated modest conclusions; presents some answers to the project objectives; shows ability to generate some limited recommendations for improvement and future work.	Demonstrated clear conclusions; presents answers to the project objectives; ability to generate robust recommendations for improvement and future work.	Demonstrates concise and reasonable conclusions; presents coherent answers to the project objectives; shows ability to generate robust, well thought out and innovative recommendations for improvement and future work.	
<i>Achievement of Objectives</i> [15%]	Little or no serious work, failure to address task; most work packages not addressed.	Little actual achievement, limited understanding.	Some weaknesses and limited in achievement, but implementation was diligent and major objectives have been addressed.	High standards, which, though failing to match up to total expectations nevertheless contained much actual achievement.	Highly competent work, with achievement up to or beyond the supervisor's expectation.	
<i>Presentation</i> [10%]	Document is poorly presented throughout indicating limited effort. A poorly organised, incomplete reference list not following appropriate style	Significant issues are present with captions and presentation of figures, tables and equations. Numerous grammatical/spelling errors. limited, structured reference list not following an appropriate style	Document is correctly formatted; Some issues with captioning and presentation of figures, tables and equations. Some grammatical/spelling errors. A modest, organised and structured reference list. Some small errors encountered.	Document is correctly formatted; Minor issues with captioning and presentation of figures, tables and equations. Presents a clearly organised and structured reference list. Minor issues in style used.	Document is correctly formatted. All figures, tables and equations correctly labelled and referred. A pleasure to read. Presents an excellent organised and structured reference list. Sufficient information to easily retrieve source given	

Individual Project – Oral Assessment Mark-Scheme

The Oral Assessment of the Individual Project involves a 10-minute presentation followed by a 20-minute Q&A session. For the introductory presentation, students must summarize their work throughout the project, clearly stating their objectives, methodology and key findings. Any issues encountered during the project (e.g., breakdown of instruments, etc.), which you think should be considered in the marking process, should also be highlighted.

Following the presentation, through further questioning the examiners may (i) seek clarification on aspects of the project as discussed in the Thesis submitted, (ii) ask the student to justify their approach to the work presented, and (iii) seek to confirm that students understand what they have written and can effectively defend it verbally.

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<i>Fulfilment of Objectives [20%]</i>	Work presented is poor and fails to address the objectives.	Little actual achievement but work is relevant to the stated objectives.	Objectives are partially addressed and work presented of a good quality.	High standard of work, which fails to fully address all objectives nevertheless contains much actual achievement.	Objectives have been entirely addressed and even expanded upon. Work is of a publishable standard.	Very little could be done to better it in any way
<i>Defence of Work [30%]</i>	Student was able to provide little to no justification for the methods employed. A coherent rationale supporting the accuracy and veracity of their findings could not be provided.	Student was able to provide little justification for the methods employed. Limited argument to support the accuracy and veracity of their findings and conclusions were provided.	Student was able to broadly justify their chosen research method and the validity of their findings and conclusions. Significant weakness in supporting arguments with theory and literature.	Student was able to justify their chosen research method and the validity of their findings and conclusions. Some weakness in supporting arguments with theory and literature.	Student was able to thoroughly justify their chosen research method and the validity of their findings and conclusions with the support of well-developed arguments rooted in theory and literature.	
<i>Understanding of the Subject [30%]</i>	Demonstrated very little or no understanding of the subject and the wider context.	Demonstrated a limited understanding of the subject and the wider context. Was largely unable to explain relevant theory and physical phenomena.	Demonstrated an understanding of the subject however, significant weaknesses evident.	Demonstrated a well-rounded understanding of the subject and the wider context however some minor weaknesses.	Demonstrated an excellent, in-depth understanding of the subject and the wider context.	
<i>Quality of Presentation [20%]</i>	Poor presentation skills. Clumsy, disjointed, difficult to follow, or dull. Significantly under or over time. Poor or no use of visual media to support the presentation. Content exceptionally difficult to understand.	Not always clear or easy to follow, unimaginative and unengaging. Significantly over time. Material fairly disorganised and rushed. Visual media used to support the presentation, however there is significant room for improvement. Lack of appropriate detail with significant issues relating to layout, fonts and colouring employed	Effectively conveys intended ideas, but is sometimes unclear or clumsy. More or less right length, but some material not covered properly as a result. Good use of visual media to support the presentation, several improvements needed. Content presented to appropriate detail with appropriate layout, fonts and colouring employed, with significant issues.	A clear, lively and engaging presentation. Good engagement with the audience. Well organised, more or less to time. Very good use of visual media to support the presentation, minor improvements needed. Most content presented to appropriate detail with appropriate layout, fonts and colouring employed, with some minor issues.	An excellent presentation. Clear, lively and engaging, presenting information in a logical order. Perfectly timed. Excellent use of visual media to support the presentation. All content presented to appropriate detail with appropriate layout, fonts and colouring employed.	